Agent 365: pilot the control plane first

Audience: Executive decision-makers
Decision: Pilot one accountable agent before scaling governance.

Executive Summary

Bottom line: use Agent 365 as the control plane for one accountable pilot; verify ownership, access, action traces, licenses, and preview limits before scaling.

Narration

Bottom line: use Agent 365 as the control plane for one accountable pilot; verify ownership, access, action traces, licenses, and preview limits before scaling.

Agent 365 is the control plane for AI agents. Ask who owns each one, where it runs, what it can reach, who it affects, and what risk needs action.

Observe with a registry, activity, and health first. Add telemetry so each request, model step, tool call, and error has a trace for operators, not guesswork.

Govern and secure access as one path. Pair lifecycle review, Entra controls, Purview data checks, and Defender signals for every agent before wider rollout.

Keep the current agent and add only needed SDK pieces. Pilot one owned use case, verify licenses and preview limits, then scale only from evidence and review.

1. 1. Name the control plane

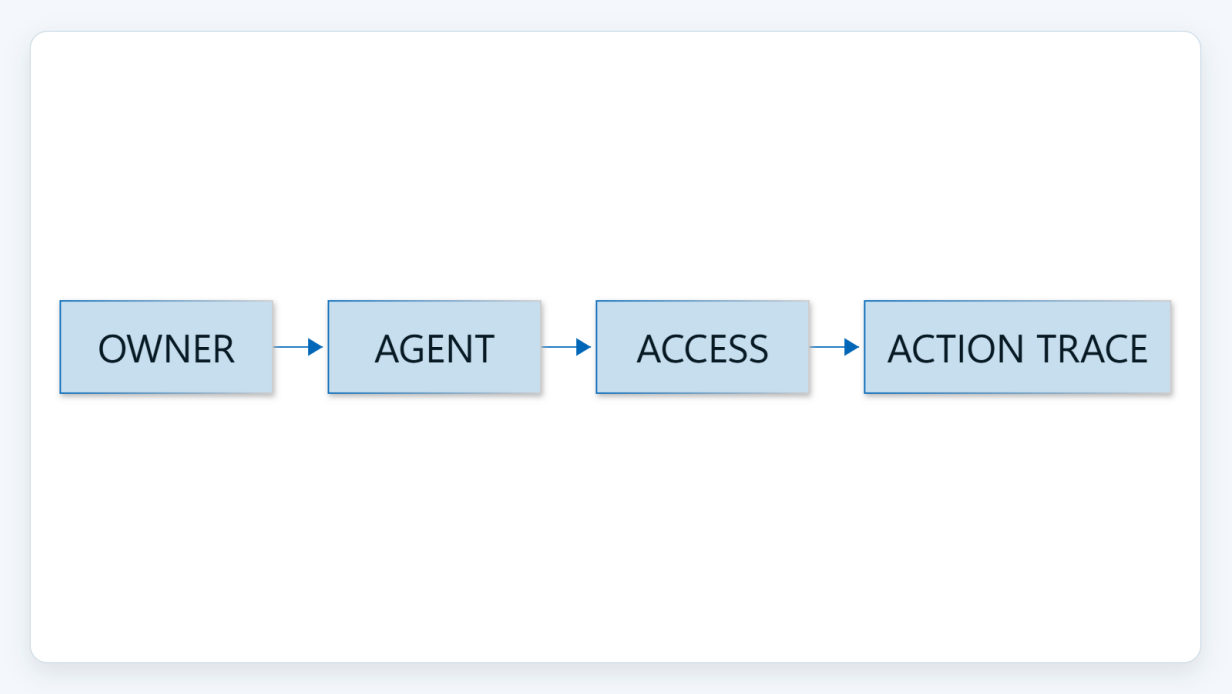
Agent 365 is the control plane for AI agents. Ask who owns each one, where it runs, what it can reach, who it affects, and what risk needs action.

Claims

- Agent 365 is a centralized control plane for observing, governing, and securing AI agents.
- A pilot must verify prerequisites, licenses, preview limits, and telemetry before scaling.

Assets and alt text

- visual-control-plane: Frame the pilot with ownership, access, and traceability before scale. (mermaid diagram) (embedded image)



Speaker notes

Evidence: service description calls Agent 365 a centralized control plane; overview states observe, govern, and secure. Interpretation: ownership and access questions make the pilot accountable.

2. 2. Observe traced work

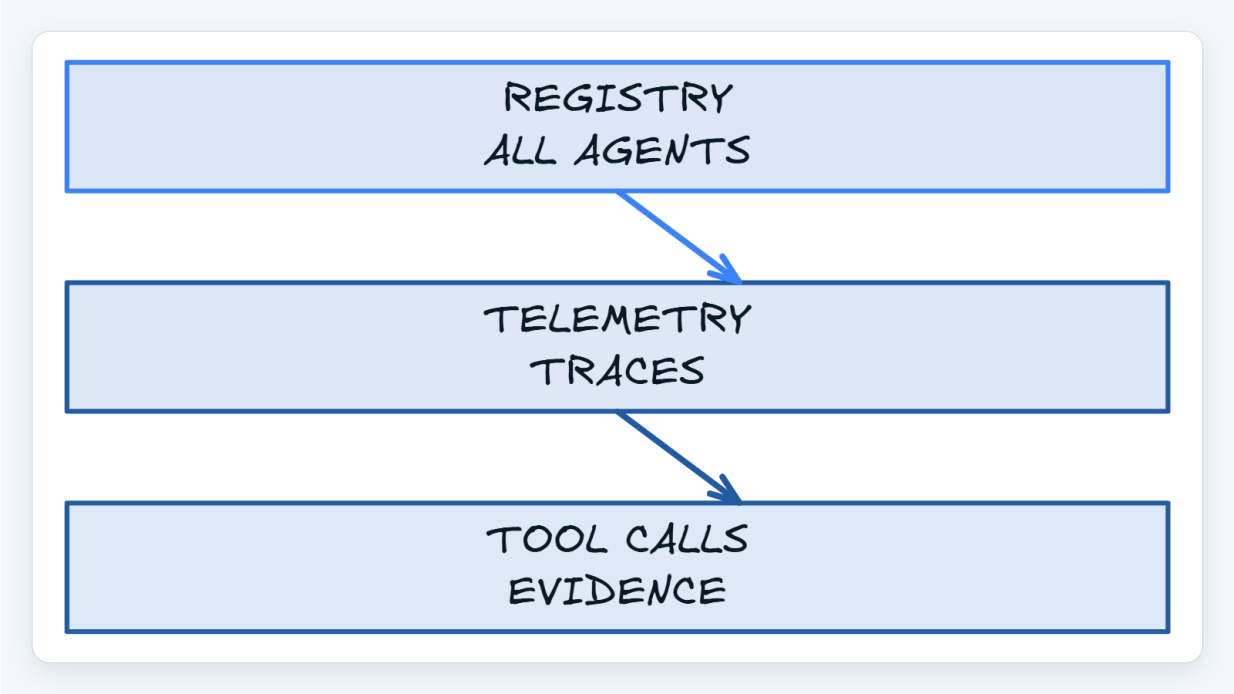
Observe with a registry, activity, and health first. Add telemetry so each request, model step, tool call, and error has a trace for operators, not guesswork.

Claims

- Observation should pair agent inventory with audited traces for interactions, inference events, and tool usage.

Assets and alt text

- visual-observe-traces: Inventory plus telemetry turns agent activity into traceable evidence. (excalidraw diagram) (embedded image)



Speaker notes

Evidence: overview describes real-time visibility into the agentic environment; SDK guidance describes audited, traceable interactions, inference events, and tool usage.

3. 3. Govern and secure access

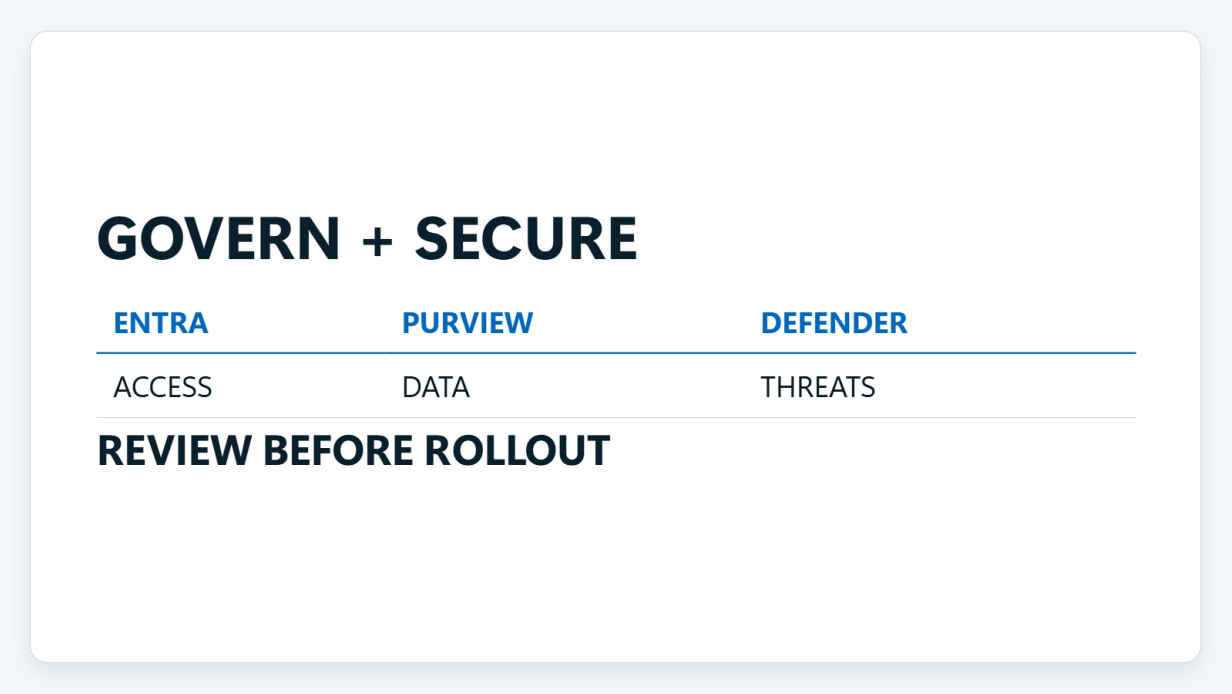
Govern and secure access as one path. Pair lifecycle review, Entra controls, Purview data checks, and Defender signals for every agent before wider rollout.

Claims

- Governance and security connect lifecycle controls, Entra permissions, Purview protection, and Defender detection.

Assets and alt text

- visual-govern-secure: Use the Microsoft control stack as one governed access path. (marp diagram) (embedded image)



Speaker notes

Evidence: overview connects registry, Microsoft 365 admin center, Entra, and Purview with lifecycle and permissions; the secure section identifies Defender threat detection.

4. 4. Pilot before expansion

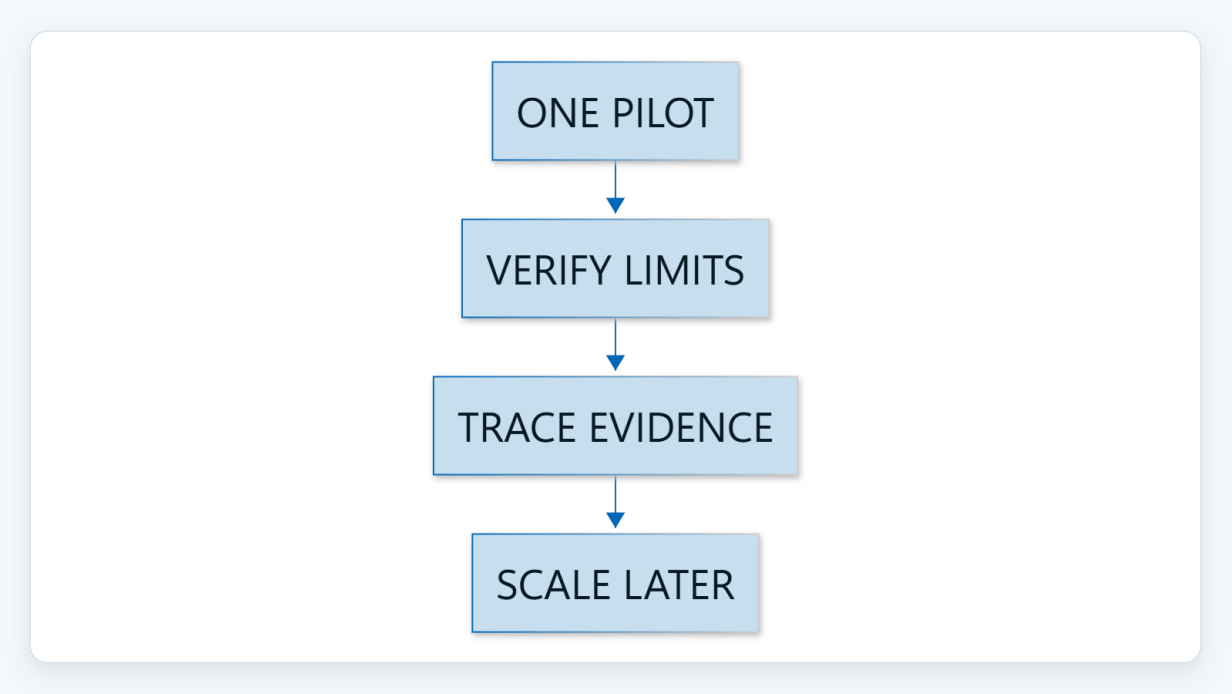
Keep the current agent and add only needed SDK pieces. Pilot one owned use case, verify licenses and preview limits, then scale only from evidence and review.

Claims

- SDK integration extends existing agents with enterprise capabilities without creating or hosting the agent.
- A pilot must verify prerequisites, licenses, preview limits, and telemetry before scaling.

Assets and alt text

• visual-accountable-pilot: Start small, prove the controls, and expand only from evidence. (mermaid diagram) (embedded image)



Speaker notes

Evidence: the SDK extends existing agents without creating or hosting them. The quickstart and service description make validation, assigned licenses, preview status, and plan availability explicit checks.

Citations

[ev-01, ev-12] Microsoft Agent 365 - Service Descriptions https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/office365/servicedescriptions/microsoft-agent-365/microsoft-agent-365 retrieved 2026-10-06T20:16:49.112Z
[ev-02, ev-03, ev-05, ev-06] Microsoft Agent 365 overview https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-agent-365/overview retrieved 2026-10-06T20:16:48.334Z
[ev-04, ev-07, ev-08] Microsoft Agent 365 SDK and CLI https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-agent-365/developer/ retrieved 2026-10-06T20:16:48.694Z
[ev-09, ev-10, ev-11] Quickstart: Connect an Existing Agent to Agent 365 https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-agent-365/developer/get-started retrieved 2026-10-06T20:16:49.394Z